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Spoils of Empire

A fantasy strategy game designed for play-by-email (PBEM)

by Rick Morneau

ram@srv.net

Until recently, the entire globe groaned under the iron-fisted rule of the old Empire. But the Empire is now dead and new bases of power are forming. You can become one of the them, or you can stand by and watch others fight for dominance. The choice is yours.

Spoils of Empire is an open-ended, computer-moderated, strategy, fantasy, role-playing game designed for play-by-email. The setting and technology are similar to that of Ancient Rome, but with one major difference: magic is both real and powerful.

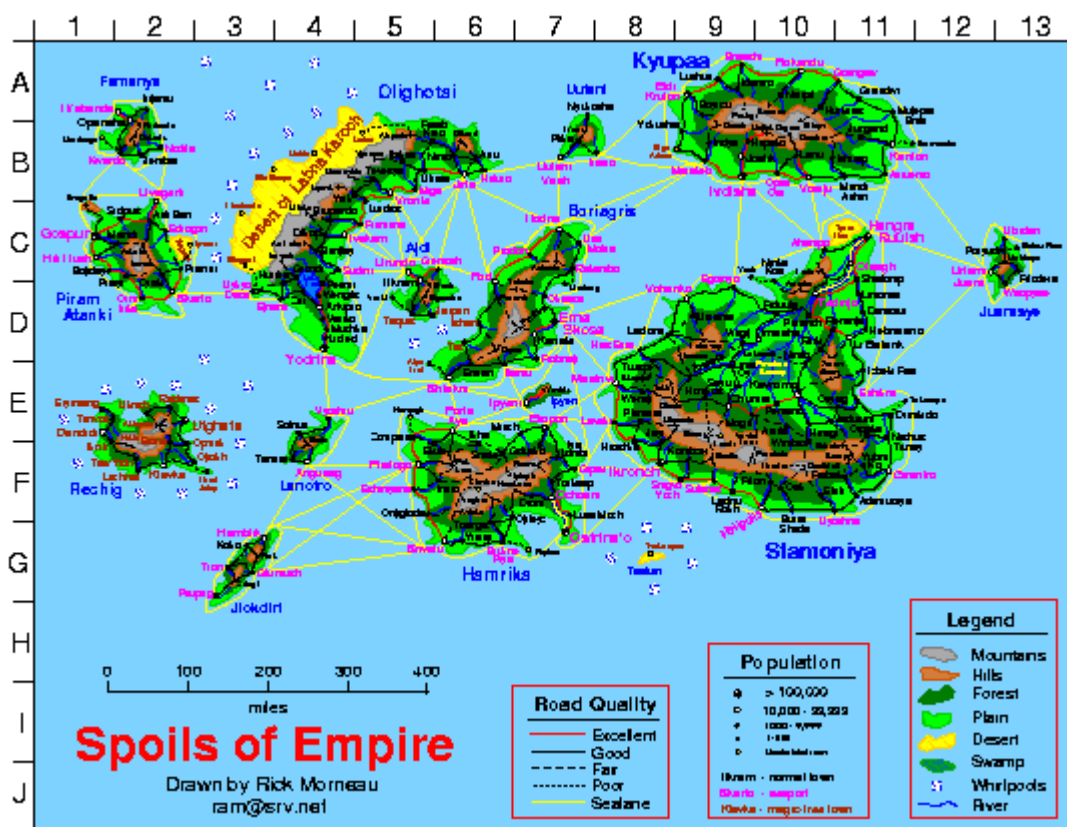
[By the way, the map on the right is a (very squished!) copy of the map that I'm currently using. However, the game is not in any way tied to a single map. In Spoils of Empire, the gamemaster is free to supply his own map.]

You will start the game with a small amount of gold which you can use to obtain an education, hire followers, and purchase any items that you need to create and define your

starting characters. From then on, you can interact with the characters of other players in whatever way you choose. You can attempt to increase your power at the expense of others, or just wander around the world and involve yourself in whatever fashion suits you.

To play Spoils of Empire, you can use any text editor on any computer to prepare your orders and read your status reports - no special software is needed. You will, of course, need to be able to send and receive email.

Unlike other games, Spoils of Empire does not require you to constantly look up complex command formats and tedious numeric codes to write your orders. Instead, the computer understands a simple but powerful subset of the English language. For example, instead of writing orders like this:



UNIT 52
CAST 716
COLLECT 82 0 0
SELL 79 123 18
ATTACK 1213
QUARRY 112 71 3

You can write your orders like this:

Have Merlin teleport Joe Flint to Madegi Doy.
Have Mike Anderson go to Benkamu and recruit 80 sailors
and buy 2 galleys.
Then have him sail to Madegi Doy and get Joe Flint, and
then sail to Kitesta and attack Genghis Khan.

The computer is even capable of detecting many spelling errors.

If you are interested in Spoils of Empire, you should first read the rules carefully. If, after reading the rules, you decide that you'd like to play, then generate your lead character as described in the rules and mail your orders to me at ram@srv.net. Since the game is open-ended, you can join an ongoing game at any time.

There is no charge for playing Spoils of Empire. I am retired and this is one of my hobbies.

- [Rules for Spoils of Empire \(250 kbytes\)](#)
- [Postscript Map \(368 kbytes\)](#)
- [Download a free Postscript viewer](#)

Other useful information:

- [Map Index](#)
- [Frequently Asked Questions \(FAQ\)](#)

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